Stryten Energy, which continually reviews new battery chemistries, charger capabilities and energy storage systems that can support fast charging in elevated environments.

“Operations are changing so much that everyone’s looking at different factors on how to get the most out of those operations, and what solutions they need to get there,” says McCusker.

The right battery energy storage system (BESS), for example, can help an organization maximize its existing footprint while also adding sustainability gains and other advantages. “It’s about getting the most out of every square foot of the warehouse,” says McCusker.

4) Companies want to charge on the go. Interest in a portable and integrated battery charging solution is high right now as organizations pivot away from traditional, fixed charging infrastructures.

Those with rental fleets and smaller storefronts are especially interested in being able to “charge on the go,” according to Schneider, who says Green Cubes is responding by offering options like integrated chargers built directly into lithium-ion batteries.

The solution is appealing to customers that may not have a dedicated charging room (or the infrastructure to support one). Portable charging also simplifies logistics, making it easier to deploy and manage lift trucks in pop-up distribution points or in facilities that have limited space availability.

5) Connectivity is big business, but it’s not quite there yet. There’s also been a lot of buzz lately around “connected batteries,” but not all solutions offer the kind of connectivity that companies are looking for.

“There are a lot of portals being introduced; everyone is talking about it,” says Beauchamp. Some of those platforms aren’t exactly ready for prime time, however, with the critical piece being the translation of the data into meaningful insights that companies can actually use.

“Everybody talks about connected batteries, but no one is effectively transforming this information into something that’s actionable for customers,” says Beauchamp, who expects the technology to continue improving and advancing to the point where companies will be able to use a simple interface to manage their batteries.

“The future will be transforming scientific information that’s not useful for customers into essential information that they can take action on,” he says.